

SKILLS GUIDE



Good communication skills for preparing reports and presenting the results of experiments.



The ability to lead and motivate others in a team, and supervise or train junior team members.



Sharp analytical skills to interpret data from experiments and peer-reviewed publications.



Strong problem-solving skills for improving medicines during the drug-development phase.



Excellent computer skills to record test results and analyze complex data.



Acute observational skills and an attention to detail in carrying out precise scientific work.



NEUROPHARMACOLOGIST Studies how nerve cells and human behavior are affected by drugs, and develops new medicines to treat conditions such as depression and bipolar disorder.



CLINICAL PHARMACOLOGIST Drafts guidelines for how and when medicines should be prescribed, runs clinical trials of new drugs, and monitors the effectiveness and possible side effects of medicines.



UNIVERSITY RESEARCHER Works in a university pharmacology department, leading teams undertaking research projects and experiments, teaching and supervising students, and performing administration and management tasks.

RELATED CAREERS

- ▶ **MICROBIOLOGIST** *see pp. 138–139*
- ▶ **FORENSIC SCIENTIST** *see pp. 146–147*
- ▶ **MEDICAL DOCTOR** *see pp. 276–277*
- ▶ **PHARMACIST** *see pp. 284–285*
- ▶ **BIOCHEMIST** Conducts scientific research into chemical reactions that take place inside living organisms. Biochemists study DNA, proteins, and cells to observe the effects of drugs, foods, allergies, and diseases.
- ▶ **BIOMEDICAL RESEARCH SCIENTIST** Performs clinical trials and laboratory tests to research new treatments for diseases and other health issues.

AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Chemistry • Biology • Physics • Mathematics • Information Technology (IT) • Health and medicine



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS An advanced degree, such as a doctor of pharmacy degree, is required in order to work as a pharmacologist.



LIFESTYLE Working hours are regular, but weekend or shift work may be required to monitor experiments. Part-time hours may be available.



LOCATION Pharmacological work is primarily laboratory- or office-based, but traveling to scientific conferences is a common part of the job.



THE REALITIES Laboratory analysis may be repetitive and involve working with hazardous chemicals. Some roles involve animal testing.